

food you *do* buy so you don't have to run to the store as often, and can make more meals, for less money.

Don't create meals that require oddball or expensive ingredients either. It's best to stick to the basics when budgets are tight, and shop seasonally whenever possible. A food specific Pinterest board is a great idea to collect inspiration and try new recipes. You also might want to visit a few of my favorite frugal foodie blogs too:

- BudgetBytes.com
- GoodCheapEats.com
- CheapRecipeBlog.com

If you want a ready-made meal plan that does all the work for you, I highly recommend eMeals. This meal planning service matches up recipes with grocery store sales and offers over twenty different plans according to tastes and preferences. It does cost a tiny subscription per month, but the budget-friendly plan can cut costs to \$85/week for a family of four! Visit CreativeSavingsBlog.com/eMeals to sign up for a free trial.

READER TIP:

Our family is building a greenhouse this fall so we can utilize it immediately starting in the spring! We intend to grow our own things to make veggies—something we don't have to buy.

—Naomi, PA

3. EAT LEFTOVERS

I'm not a huge fan of leftovers, but in an effort to eliminate food waste, both Joseph and I have learned to tolerate them a little bit more. One of my tricks is to freeze individual leftovers rather than sticking them in the fridge until they mold. This is particularly helpful if we have something like extra biscuits or soup, because we can just freeze the rest for another busy night.